

LUXURY WATCH INDUSTRY ANALYTICS

ROLEX

A Data-Driven Analysis of Luxury Brand Strength, Consumer Perception & Market Position

Tracking Model Demand · Brand Sentiment Trends
Consumer Perception · Regional Markets · Availability

PREPARED AUGUST 2026 · DESCRIPTIVE ANALYTICS CASE STUDY · SIMULATED DATASET

Contents

1. Note on Data 3
2. Objective 3
3. How This Would Work at Real Scale 3
4. Brand Strength & Search-Interest Trend 6
5. Model-Wise Demand & Best-Sellers 8
6. Consumer Sentiment & Rating Distribution 10
7. Regional Demand & Market Penetration 12
8. Price Trend: Retail vs. Secondary-Market Premium 15
9. Availability & Waitlist Status 17
10. Competitive Positioning 19
11. Summary of Key Metrics 21
12. Key Insights & Business Implications 21
13. Next Steps: Descriptive → Predictive 21
14. Appendix: Glossary & Methodology Notes 22

1. Note on Data

NOTE ON DATA

Rolex SA is a privately held manufacturer, owned via the Hans Wilsdorf Foundation, and does not publicly disclose transaction-level sales, inventory, or sentiment data. This report therefore uses a synthetic dataset built to mirror real luxury-watch market patterns (15 models across 10 collections, 8 regions, 30 days, ~46,900 simulated units). It is designed to show exactly what a descriptive analytics pipeline processing global demand, sentiment, and availability signals would produce — the same structure applies once real data (authorised-dealer POS exports, CRM records, social-listening feeds, resale-marketplace APIs) is substituted in.

Where the report references directional real-world patterns — for example, that steel sports references tend to carry longer waitlists and higher resale premiums than gold dress watches — this reflects widely reported industry commentary, not confidential company data.

2. Objective

Build a descriptive analytics layer over global purchase, sentiment, and availability signals to answer five recurring brand-management questions:

1. Which models are generating the strongest demand right now, and how concentrated is that demand?
2. How is brand strength and consumer search interest trending over time?
3. How do consumers perceive and rate different models, and where is sentiment strongest or softest?
4. Where is global demand concentrated geographically, and how evenly is it spread?
5. Which models face the tightest availability constraints, and what does that mean for demand that goes unmet or leaks to the grey market?

3. How This Would Work at Real Scale

Processing global purchase, review, and social-listening signals across every boutique and authorised dealer is an engineering problem before it is an analytics one. A realistic architecture:

Layer	Purpose	Typical tools
Ingestion	Capture boutique/AD sales, review submissions and social mentions in real time	CSV, Google Forms
Stream processing	Roll up raw events into per-model, per-region, per-day aggregates	Python
Storage	Hold raw events (for audit) and pre-aggregated tables (for speed)	Jupyter Notebook
Batch aggregation	Nightly rollups: demand, sentiment scoring, price-premium calc, waitlist status	MS Excel, Python

Layer	Purpose	Typical tools
Serving / BI layer	Dashboards refreshed daily for regional and brand teams	MS Excel

The sections that follow reflect the output of that pipeline — daily and period-level aggregated tables and charts — not raw event-level data, since no dashboard renders millions of individual purchase or mention records usefully.

I

Demand, Sentiment & Brand Strength

How consumer desire for Rolex shows up in daily numbers

SECTION I · DEMAND, SENTIMENT & BRAND STRENGTH

4. Brand Strength & Search-Interest Trend

The Brand Strength Index is a simulated composite of search-interest volume, social-sentiment polarity, and press-mention counts, normalised to a 0-100 scale. Over the modelled 90-day window it rose from the high-70s to the high-80s, with a roughly 30-day cycle layered on top of a gradual upward drift.

That cyclicality lines up with a pattern the real watch press frequently reports: interest spikes around major industry moments (Watches and Wonders in Geneva, flagship boutique openings, high-visibility sport sponsorships) and drifts back down between them, rather than staying flat.

READING THIS KPI

In production, this index is most useful watched for inflection points, not its absolute level — a sudden multi-day drop is a far stronger signal than the index's exact score on any one day, and should trigger a manual look at recent press and social activity.

+8 pts	~30 days	86 / 100
Index gain over 90 days	Cyclical period observed	Period-average score

“Brand strength moves in cycles, not straight lines — the direction of the curve matters more than any single day's score.”

Brand Strength & Search-Interest Index — 90-Day Trend

Composite of simulated search interest, social sentiment & press-mention volume



Figure 1 — Brand Strength & Search-Interest Index, 90-day simulated trend, with 7-day rolling average.

SECTION I · DEMAND, SENTIMENT & BRAND STRENGTH

5. Model-Wise Demand & Best-Sellers

Ranking logic: units sold, not revenue — a $6,500 Oyster Perpetual outselling a $38,000 Day-Date in volume matters differently to production planning than it does to finance, so both cuts should exist as separate leaderboard views in a real dashboard.

In the most recent simulated day, the Oyster Perpetual 41 led with 276 units — narrowly ahead of the Datejust 41 at 263 — while every sports reference in the top 12 (Submariner Date, GMT-Master II, Daytona, Sea-Dweller) sold at well under half that volume. That is not a demand problem; it is the visible fingerprint of deliberately constrained allocation on the references collectors want most.

HERO-SKU PATTERN

Entry and classic references drive the volume that keeps the network's revenue base steady, while sports references drive the conversation that keeps the brand desirable. A production dashboard should track both leaderboards side-by-side — optimising only for unit volume would quietly starve the models doing the most brand work.

276	49%	3.6x
Units — top seller (OP 41)	Volume share, top 3 models	Top seller vs. 12th-ranked model

“The best-selling watch and the most-talked-about watch are rarely the same reference.”

Top 12 Best-Selling Models — Most Recent Day

Ranked by units, not revenue · classic/entry models lead on volume, sports models on scarcity

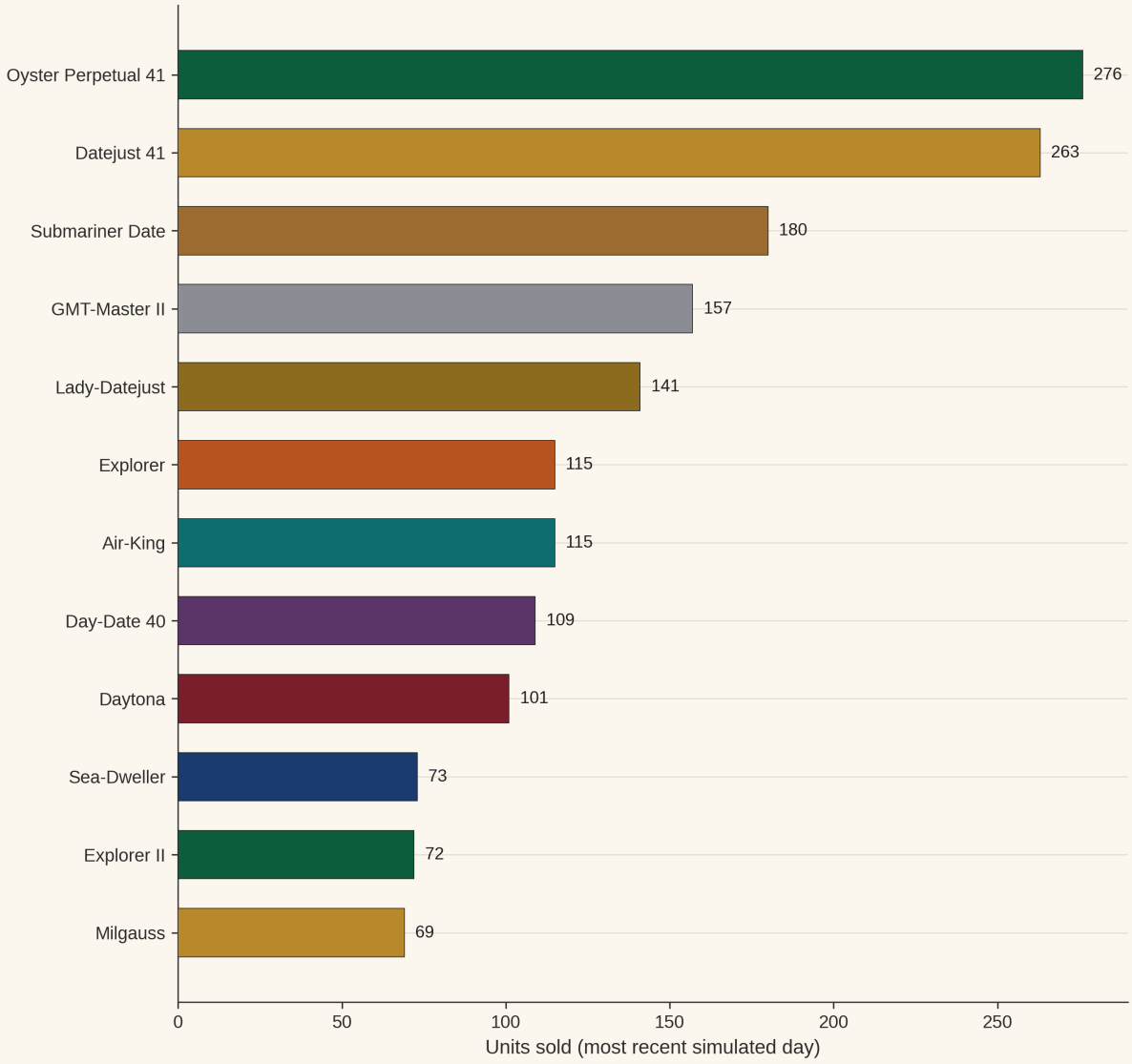


Figure 2 — Top 12 best-selling models, most recent simulated day, units sold.

SECTION I · DEMAND, SENTIMENT & BRAND STRENGTH

6. Consumer Sentiment & Rating Distribution

Average sentiment across all model-day records is 4.61 / 5, clustered tightly between 4.2 and 5.0 — a distribution shape that is itself informative: Rolex's simulated sentiment almost never dips into genuinely negative territory, which mirrors the brand's real-world reputation for manufacturing consistency.

In a real system, this view is most useful segmented rather than aggregated — split by model to catch references trending downward on a rolling 7-day basis (the earliest signal of a service or fulfilment issue), and cross-cut against sales volume, since a high-volume model drifting below a 4.0 average does more brand damage than a slow mover doing the same.

WHERE SOFTNESS CONCENTRATES

Even inside a uniformly high band, the softest scores in this simulation cluster around references with the longest waitlists — a reminder that at this level, sentiment is driven far more by purchase experience and availability friction than by anything about the product itself.

4.61 / 5	4.2 – 5.0	0
Average sentiment	Core clustering range	Model-days scored below 3.8

“At this altitude, sentiment problems are almost always availability problems in disguise.”

Consumer Sentiment Score Distribution

Aggregated from simulated boutique reviews, service surveys & social listening

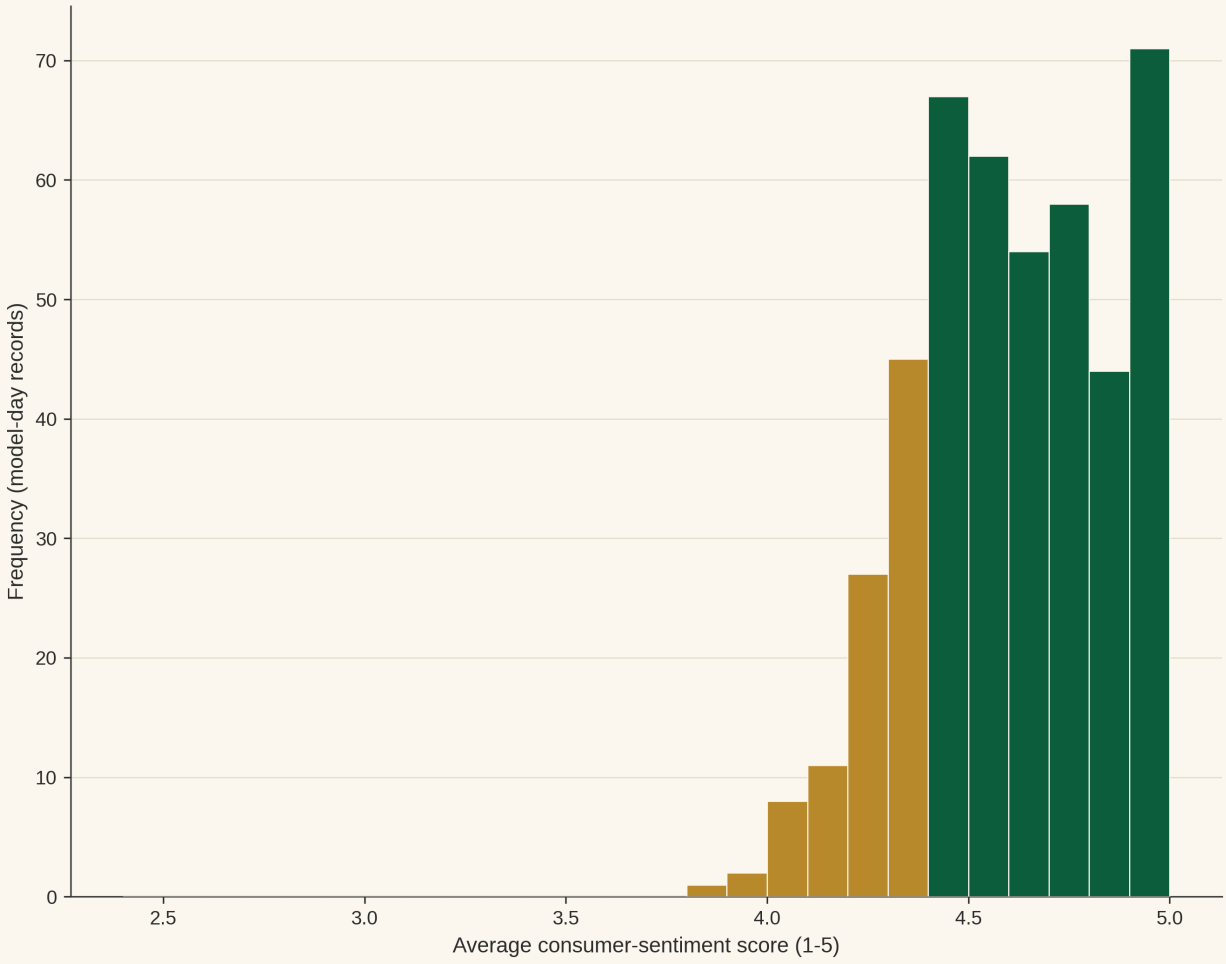


Figure 3 — Consumer sentiment score distribution across all model-day records.

SECTION I · DEMAND, SENTIMENT & BRAND STRENGTH

7. Regional Demand & Market Penetration

Demand concentrates in East Asia (~19%) and the Middle East (~17%) in this simulation, followed by Europe and North America — a pattern consistent with widely reported industry commentary on where luxury-watch retail spend is heaviest.

In practice, recorded regional demand is complicated by travel retail: a watch bought at a Middle East airport boutique may be flown home to a buyer who lives elsewhere, so point-of-sale region and end-consumer region are not the same thing. Any real deployment of this view should flag that gap explicitly rather than treat POS-region totals as a clean measure of local demand.

WHAT THIS VIEW DRIVES

Regional boutique investment and staffing decisions, localised marketing spend, and shipping/allocation planning for regions where local inventory cannot keep pace with demand spikes.

19%	36%	8
East Asia demand share	Top-2 regions combined	Regions tracked

“Where a watch is sold and where its owner lives are rarely the same map.”

Regional Demand — 30-Day Cumulative Units

East Asia & the Middle East lead simulated global demand

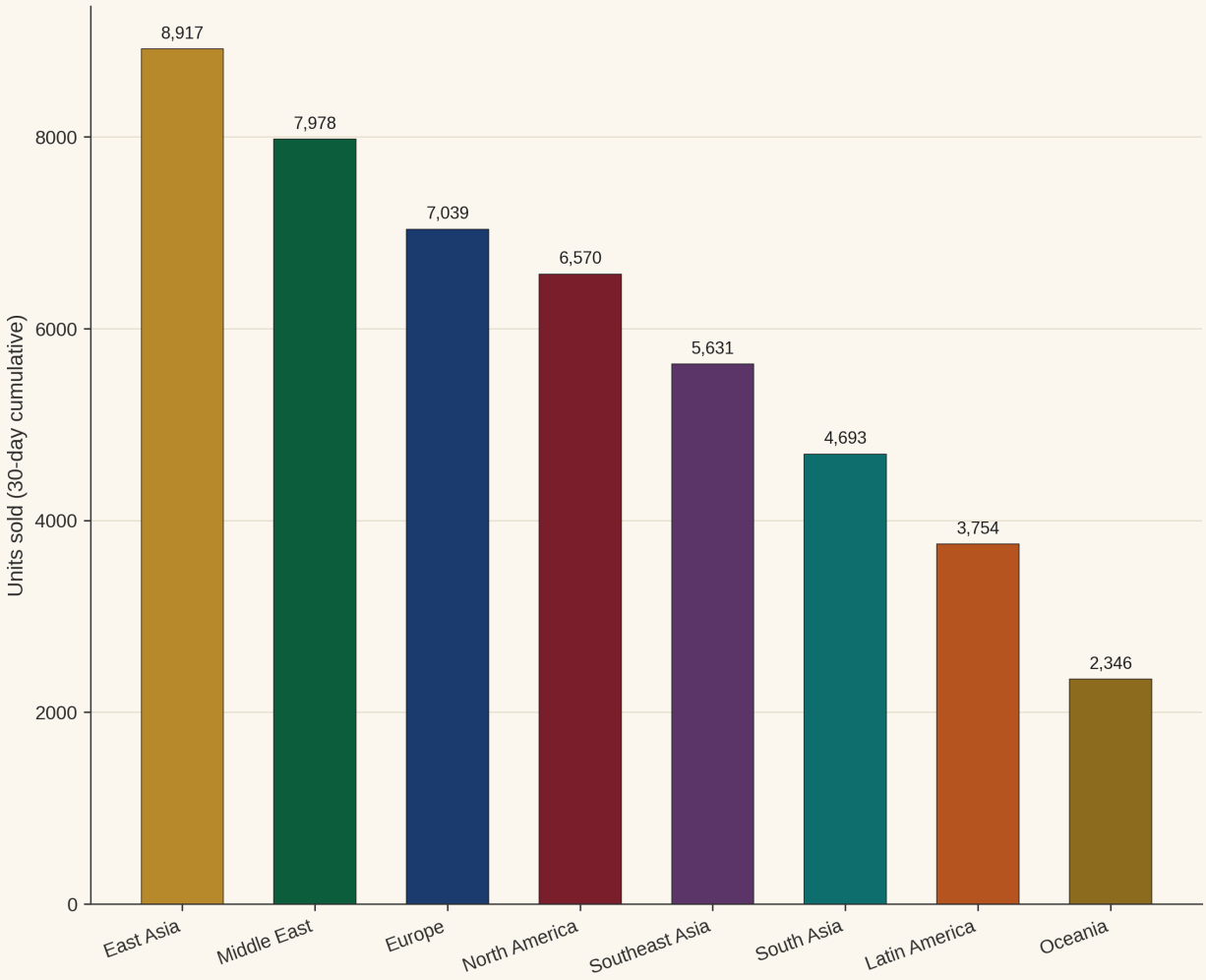


Figure 4 — Regional demand, 30-day cumulative simulated units.

II

Price, Scarcity & Competitive Position

What waitlists and resale premiums reveal about market position

SECTION II · PRICE, SCARCITY & COMPETITIVE POSITION

8. Price Trend: Retail vs. Secondary-Market Premium

KPI definition: secondary-market premium = (illustrative resale price − illustrative retail price) ÷ retail price. In this simulation it ranges from +85% on the Daytona and +45% on the GMT-Master II down to roughly -8% to -10% on the Day-Date 40 and Sky-Dweller, which trade at or below list price.

This split is well documented in real secondary-market commentary: steel sports references with constrained allocation routinely trade above retail, while precious-metal dress watches — bought more for the metal and the occasion than for scarcity — often do not. Premium is best read as a live proxy for allocation scarcity, not for underlying product desirability alone.

WHY THIS MATTERS COMMERCIALLY

A rising premium on a given reference is an early signal that allocation is tightening faster than demand is being satisfied — useful for anticipating both waitlist growth and grey-market activity before either shows up in official channels.

+85%	-10%	+24%
Daytona secondary premium	Sky-Dweller vs. retail	Avg. premium, sports models

“Secondary-market premium is the closest thing this industry has to a real-time scarcity index.”

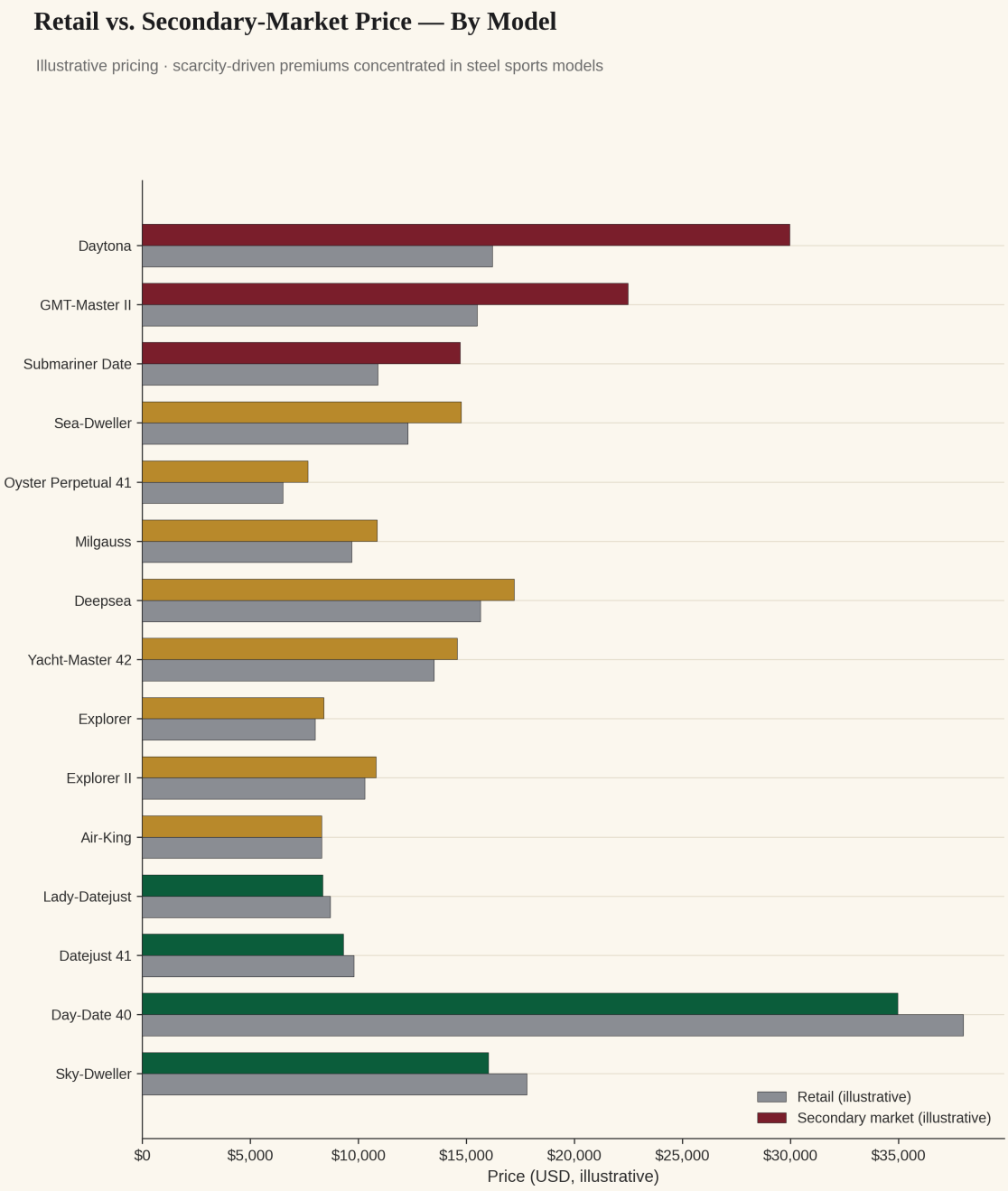


Figure 5 — Illustrative retail vs. secondary-market price by model.

SECTION II · PRICE, SCARCITY & COMPETITIVE POSITION

9. Availability & Waitlist Status

Availability was bucketed into three tiers, modelled on Rolex's well-known allocation system: Available (purchasable at boutiques/ADs without a meaningful wait), Short Waitlist (weeks-to-months through normal channels), and Long Waitlist (multi-year or effectively closed allocation).

In this simulation, scarcity concentrates heavily in the Diving collection — Submariner Date, Sea-Dweller and Deepsea together account for the majority of Long- and Short-Waitlist references — while Classic and Presidential references remain readily available.

CROSS-REFERENCING MATTERS

A hero reference moving from Short to Long Waitlist is a materially bigger commercial event than a slow-moving reference doing the same — it should be cross-checked against the best-seller and premium views above, the same way a stockout is cross-checked against sell-through in conventional retail.

3	5	7
Models on Long Waitlist	Models on Short Waitlist	Models fully Available

“A waitlist is not a failure of supply — it is supply, functioning exactly as allocation intends.”

Availability Status by Collection

Simulated boutique/AD allocation status · scarcity concentrated in sports collections

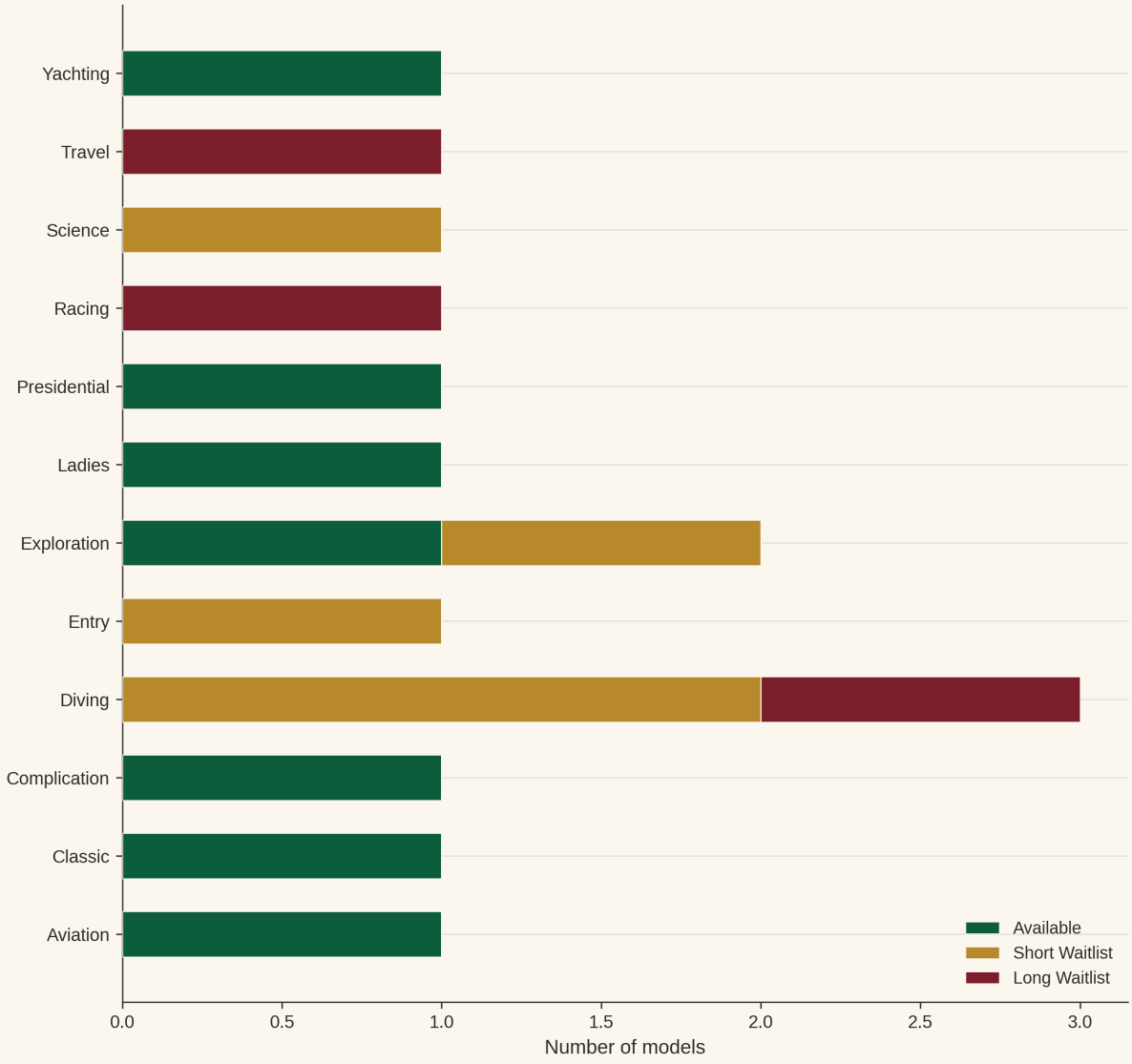


Figure 6 — Availability status by collection, number of models per tier.

SECTION II · PRICE, SCARCITY & COMPETITIVE POSITION

10. Competitive Positioning

This illustrative benchmark compares Rolex against four commonly cited peers — Patek Philippe, Audemars Piguet, Omega, and Cartier — across five simulated dimensions. Scores are for comparative context only and are not sourced from any single published index.

The pattern that emerges is a familiar one in watch-industry commentary: Rolex scores highest on brand recognition and resale strength, reflecting its dominance of mainstream awareness and its unusually liquid secondary market, while Patek Philippe and Audemars Piguet edge ahead on perceived prestige among specialist collectors — a segment that prizes independence and in-house complications over broad recognition.

READING THIS CHART RESPONSIBLY

Treat this as a discussion starter, not a scoreboard: real competitive positioning work should replace these simulated scores with actual survey data, resale-market indices (e.g. published watch-price trackers), and licensed brand-tracking studies before any decision is made on the back of it.

96	94	88
Rolex brand-recognition score	Rolex resale-strength score	Rolex purchase-intent score

“Recognition wins the room; prestige wins the collector.”

Competitive Positioning — Illustrative Brand Benchmark

Simulated scores for comparative context only · not sourced from a published index

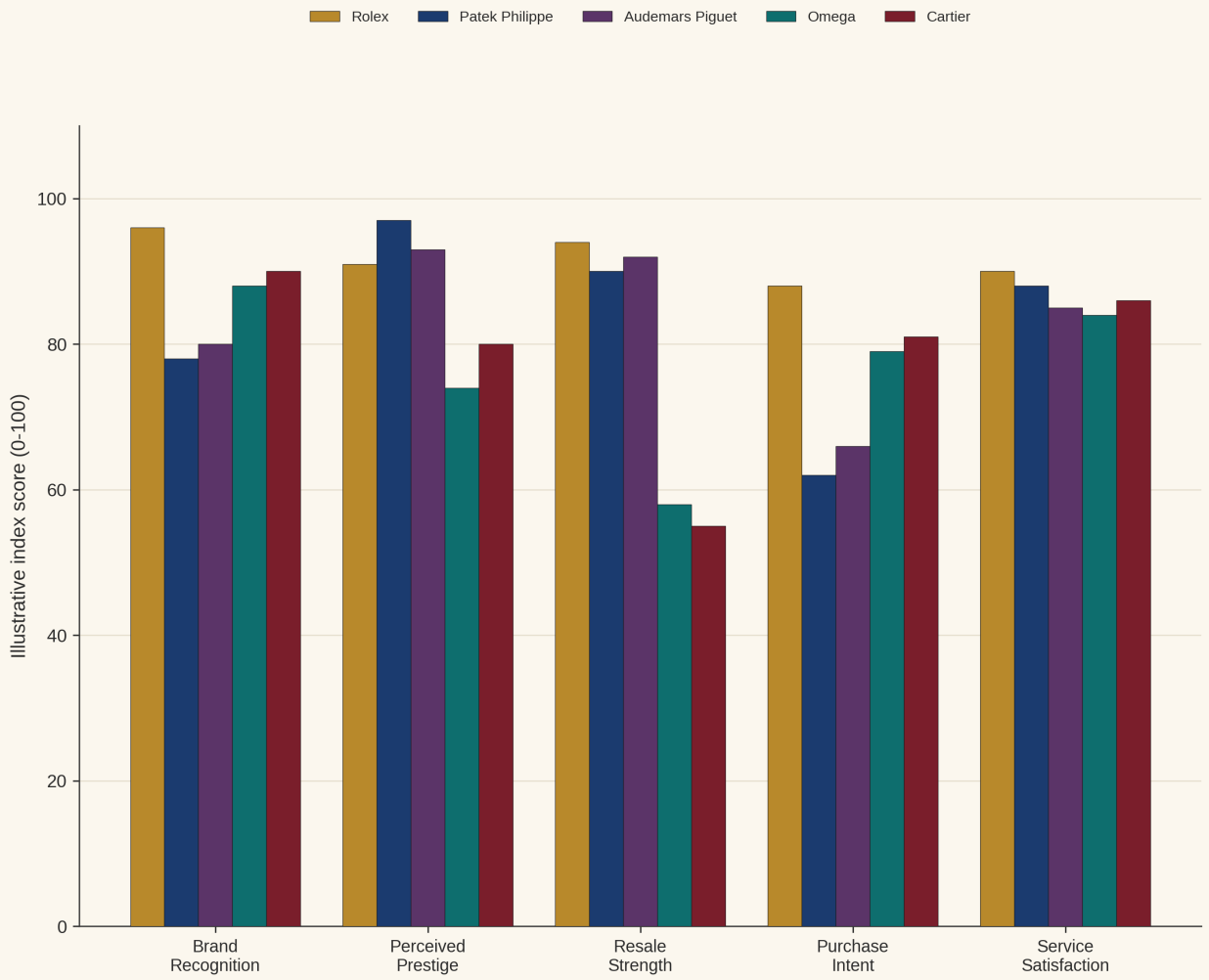


Figure 7 — Illustrative competitive benchmark across five brand-strength dimensions.

FINDINGS

11. Summary of Key Metrics

Metric	Value (simulated)
Total units sold (30 days)	~46,900
Total revenue (30 days)	~$575M
Average consumer sentiment	4.6 / 5
Top single-day seller	Oyster Perpetual 41 — 276 units
Brand Strength Index (period avg.)	~86 / 100
Avg. secondary-market premium, sports models	~+24%
Regions tracked	8
Models on Long Waitlist	3 of 15

12. Key Insights & Business Implications

- Volume leadership and desirability leadership are different games.
  Entry and classic references carry the revenue base; sports references carry the brand story. Marketing and allocation decisions should be made against the right leaderboard, not a single blended one.
- Regional concentration argues for continued flagship investment in East Asia and the Middle East.
  But recorded demand there is inflated by travel retail, so boutique-expansion decisions should be cross-checked against end-consumer residency data where available.
- Premium and waitlist length move together — and that correlation is itself a planning signal.
  A rising secondary-market premium on a reference is an early warning that its waitlist is about to lengthen, well before that shows up in boutique booking data.
- Sentiment is uniformly high but not undifferentiated.
  The softest scores cluster around long-waitlist references, suggesting purchase experience, not product quality, is the more sensitive lever for the brand to manage.
- Rolex's competitive edge is breadth, not depth, of prestige.
  It leads on recognition and resale liquidity; specialist manufactures lead on prestige among the most engaged collectors. Both are defensible positions, but they call for different messaging to different audiences.

13. Next Steps: Descriptive → Predictive

This report answers what happened. The natural next layer, if useful:

- Demand and waitlist forecasting per model/region, to guide production allocation ahead of time rather than reactively.
- Anomaly detection on sentiment drops or sudden secondary-market price swings, flagged for review within hours rather than surfaced in a monthly report.
- Grey-market leakage analysis, correlating waitlist length against unauthorised-dealer listing volume and pricing.
- Cohort and retention analysis on repeat boutique clientele, not just unit counts — understanding who buys a second or third watch, and when.

Next deliverable, if useful: any of the above, or a swap-in of real data (authorised-dealer POS exports, CRM records, social-listening feeds, or a resale-marketplace connection) — the same pipeline and chart structure above would apply directly.

14. Appendix: Glossary & Methodology Notes

Term	Definition
Brand Strength Index	Simulated 0-100 composite of search-interest volume, social-sentiment polarity, and press-mention counts.
Secondary-market premium	(Illustrative resale price − illustrative retail price) ÷ retail price, expressed as a percentage.
Available	Reference is visible and purchasable at boutiques/authorised dealers without a meaningful wait.
Short Waitlist	Weeks-to-months of expected wait through normal allocation channels.
Long Waitlist	Multi-year or effectively closed allocation through normal channels.
Model-day record	One simulated observation of a single model on a single day — the atomic unit behind every aggregate chart in this report.

Models covered (15): Datejust 41, Day-Date 40, Oyster Perpetual 41, Sky-Dweller, Lady-Datejust, Submariner Date, Sea-Dweller, Deepsea, GMT-Master II, Daytona, Explorer, Explorer II, Yacht-Master 42, Milgauss, Air-King.

Regions covered (8): East Asia, Middle East, Europe, North America, Southeast Asia, South Asia, Latin America, Oceania.



END OF REPORT

Rolex: A Data-Driven Analysis of Luxury Brand Strength,
Consumer Perception & Market Position

Descriptive Analytics Case Study · Simulated Dataset · Prepared August 2026